

A HEALTHY AND BALANCED DIET | EXERCISE 1

Do you meet the recommended daily portions?

Use the template below to log your food intake on a typical day and then categorise them into the 4 food groups as shown in the example. Compare your total portions consumed of each food group with the recommended portions and over the next few weeks, try to adjust your diet to reflect the recommendations.

Example table, blank template on next page:

MEAL		 FRUIT & VEGETABLES	 STARCHY FOODS	 PROTEIN FOODS	 DAIRY / ALTERNATIVES
Breakfast	Porridge with milk, kiwi, handful of nuts	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
Morning Snack	Carrot sticks	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Lunch	Prawns in wholemeal bread. Pot of natural yogurt, pomegranate seeds added	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☒ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
Afternoon snack	Banana	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Evening meal	Salmon, broccoli, leeks, wholegrain rice. Stewed apple	☒ ☒ ☒	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Milk in tea/ coffee (half portion)		☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
TOTAL PORTIONS PER DAY		7	3	4	3

Recommended daily portions

 FRUIT & VEGETABLES At least 5 portions	 STARCHY FOODS 3-4 portions	 PROTEIN FOODS 2-3 portions	 DAIRY / ALTERNATIVES 2-3 portions	 UNSATURATED OILS & SPREADS Small amounts
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A HEALTHY AND BALANCED DIET | EXERCISE 2

Keep a food diary

This exercise takes a more detailed look at your intake of macro and micro-nutrients and eating pattern, helping you to assess your current eating habits, the impact this has on your mood and energy levels, and highlights areas you can tackle to improve your nutrition and well-being:

1

LOG YOUR CURRENT FOOD INTAKE

Using one of these Nutrition Apps, log your current food intake over 3-4 days, one of which should include a weekend day. You should try not to alter your food choices or eating pattern at this stage.

At the same time, log your energy levels, mood and eating window.

You should also be able to assess your ideal daily calorie intake with the APP. If not, then use the one provided by freedieting.com/calorie-calculator.



2

REVIEW YOUR DIARY –

- Are you eating too much processed food, fats, sugars?
- Are you snacking into the evening?
- Perhaps you are missing meals and then over-eating at the next meal, or having unhealthy snacks throughout the day?
- How is your balance of Fats: Carbohydrates: Proteins?
- Are you getting the right micronutrients and drinking enough water?
- Can you see a connection between feeling tired or irritable and the types of food you are eating?

3

SET YOURSELF A GOAL

Having critically evaluated this diary, set yourself a goal, such as to reduce unhealthy snacking &/or replace it with healthy snacks, to have regular mealtimes, eat more fruit and vegetables, and then make the required adjustments to your diet.

Don't try to change too much at once, it will increase your chance of success if you focus on 1-2 goals.

4

MAKE ADJUSTMENTS

With your goal in mind, make adjustments to your diet to make healthier food choices at the required daily calorie level, using the APP.

Remember to keep a log of your mood, energy levels and eating window.

After 3-4 weeks complete another food/mood/energy diary and see the results!

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Healthy Recipes to get you started



BIRCHER MUESLI (1 Serving)

Premix and keep in the fridge overnight.

- 125g rolled oats
- 1 green apple, chopped
- 1 pinch cinnamon
- 2 tablespoons natural Greek yogurt
- 25g sultanas
- 1 tablespoon honey (preferably raw)
- 150ml semi-skimmed milk

473kcal	
Carbohydrates	85g
Protein	13g
Fat	9g
Fibre	8.25g

High in: Fibre, potassium, calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, selenium, iodine, vitamin A, vitamin C



BREAKFAST IN A GLASS (1 Serving)

Blend ingredients and store in the fridge or drink directly.

- 1 small banana
- 1 pear
- 100ml semi-skimmed milk
- 40g natural Greek yogurt
- ½ tablespoon chia seeds
- ½ tablespoon sunflower seeds or milled flaxseed
- 1 tablespoon unsalted peanut butter

427kcal	
Carbohydrates	184 kcal / 46g
Protein	58 kcal / 14.5g
Fat	186 kcal / 20.5g
Fibre	10g

High in: potassium, calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, iron, zinc, iodine, vit E, vit C, folate, biotin



MAKE YOUR OWN TRAILMIX (10-15 servings)

Premix and carry with you so that you have a healthy snack to hand.

- | | |
|------------------------------|-----------------------|
| 50g pistachio nuts (shelled) | 40g dried cranberries |
| 35g walnuts | 45g sultanas |
| 35g hazelnuts | 35g pumpkin seeds |
| 22g cashew nuts | 30g sunflower seeds |
| 27g almonds | |